

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager, digital products end to end.*

Positioning, 13 years owning product across regulated industries, consulting environments, and distributed agile teams, now bringing that to Monks.

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§ WHY MONKS

Monks sits at an interesting intersection: a consulting business that has to ship real digital products, not just recommendations. The Monks.Flow AI ecosystem for marketing orchestration is a concrete example of a company building its own product layer on top of services, that requires the same discipline as any SaaS roadmap. The expectation that a Senior Product Manager here acts as a trusted advisor to clients while also leading agile delivery is exactly the model I have worked in across EMIL Group, Bundesagentur für Arbeit, and Rohde & Schwarz.

That combination of internal delivery rigour and external client accountability is where I do my clearest work.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case coverage
- **GitHub Copilot**, day-to-day coding assist in VSCode
- **Cursor**, context-aware refactors across large codebases
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping from requirements
- **Framer**, design-heavy interactive mockups
- **Gamma.app**, fast stakeholder-ready presentations
- **GPT**, research, synthesis, and discovery prep
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation and multi-step agent loops

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps rollout and rollback, Jenkins, CI/CD pipelines, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin with Spring Boot, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, SQL, all in production contexts across defence AI, public-sector data platforms, healthcare, insurance SaaS, and fintech.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace for construction staffing, built zero to one alone.

- Matches construction firms with workers, cutting the headhunter from the hire with an anonymity-until-payment model.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the product surface; LLM agents across the funnel so one person runs day-to-day operations.
 - Funnel and conversion tracking in SQL; full discovery, prioritisation, and iteration cycle owned solo.
 - Demonstrates the same consulting-style product thinking Monks needs: client problem first, lightweight delivery, measurable outcome.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MONKS

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow active client engagements, read existing roadmaps and backlogs, and identify where discovery is thin or stakeholder alignment is shaky, the gaps that slow delivery.

WEEK 2

Clarify, prioritise, align.

Run a focused prioritisation session with the client and the cross-functional team, get explicit agreement on KPIs and success measures, and surface any dependency or risk hiding in the backlog.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Lead agile ceremonies, unblock the team, and close the loop between metrics and the next sprint, so the client sees output and outcome moving together.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Monks team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Manager role. I have 13 years of product ownership across defence AI, public-sector analytics, insurance SaaS, healthcare, payments, and fintech, always in environments where I had to earn client trust while also keeping a distributed engineering team pointed at the right problem.

The work at Monks is a direct match for how I operate. At EMIL Group I joined a struggling 18-person delivery organisation, restructured it into three lean teams with their own leads, rebuilt client confidence, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production. At Bundesagentur für Arbeit I owned a national labour-market analytics platform, introduced Dagster and dbt to cut data-update time by around 75%, and served concurrently as Deputy IT Security Officer. At Rohde & Schwarz I led a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists building the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European defence programme, and cut rollout time from days to 30 minutes by championing GitOps with ArgoCD. Each of these involved exactly what the role description names: continuous discovery, backlog ownership, KPI definition, and stakeholder alignment across engineering, design, and delivery, in a globally distributed Scrum setup tracked in Jira.

I work with AI tooling daily, Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, and n8n for agentic workflows, so the Monks.Flow AI ecosystem for marketing orchestration is a product space I can engage with technically, not just conceptually. I can prototype, write user stories with precise acceptance criteria, and have a credible conversation with the engineers building it.

On the consulting side: I have worked as an embedded product lead for clients rather than internal product teams for most of my career. I know what it takes to show up, understand a client's business fast, make product decisions the client trusts, and hand off something that keeps running after the engagement ends.

I would be glad to talk through any of this in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ PROFILE

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of product ownership across consulting, SaaS, public sector, insurance, defence AI, healthcare, and fintech. I act as a trusted advisor to clients and internal stakeholders, run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user research into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery using Scrum, Kanban, and SAFe. I am comfortable owning the full product lifecycle, from discovery and requirements workshops to launch, iteration, and KPI tracking in Jira, Figma, and Miro.

§ HOW I WORK

- I leave my ego at home. I want to drive the decision, not to have the last word.
 - On a new product I spend a little to learn before spending a lot to build. Cheap experiments make expensive decisions safe(r).
 - Outcome over output. Producing something is not the achievement; it also has to fit a market, so I agree what would count as success before we build and check afterwards whether it happened.
 - I keep the whole value chain in view, not just the backlog. Defect-to-fix time is a product metric; architects and DevOps engineers build that chain, my job is to steer it into the right lanes.
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§ WORK EXPERIENCE

PRODUCT MANAGER, ROHDE & SCHWARZ, MUNICH / REMOTE | 07/2024 - 05/2025

Defence and aerospace. Internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme.

- Spearheaded development of the internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme, managing a cross-functional team of 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum in Jira and Confluence.
- Championed GitOps delivery and test automation with ArgoCD, reducing rollout time from days to 30 minutes and making the platform hotfix-capable across multinational teams.
- Redirected product strategy based on user workflow analysis, increasing pipeline runs by 200% by prioritising developer-code-first over UI-led design.

PRODUCT MANAGER, BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT (FEDERAL EMPLOYMENT AGENCY), NUREMBERG / REMOTE | 05/2023 - 07/2024

Public sector. National labour-market analytics platform for policymakers and researchers. Deputy IT Security Officer.

- Introduced Dagster and dbt so quarterly imports and new indicators ran without hand-holding, saving almost 75% of the time per data update; integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline and freed several QA hours weekly.
- Migrated a bare-metal system fully into containers and carried a full UI relaunch and a large ETL migration through the same period.

PRODUCT OWNER, CLINET PLATFORMS, BERLIN | 01/2023 - 07/2023

Healthcare. Mobile patient app for iOS and Android, piloted in hospitals.

- Cut a roadmap a five-person team could not deliver to the top 10% of features against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose more than fivefold.
- Implemented the CGM interface into hospital KIS workflows: digital anamnesis dropped from 30 minutes to 5 from form to database.

PRODUCT MANAGER, EMIL GROUP, BERLIN | 04/2022 - 12/2022

Insurance. B2B SaaS platform for insurers, reinsurers, brokers and underwriters.

- Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams with their own leads: attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure.
- Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production with no precedent; cut time-to-market for a new insurance product from months to less than a week.

PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION TEAM, SCHEIDT & BACHMANN FUEL & CONVENIENCE RETAIL, MÖNCHENGLADBACH | 09/2021 - 03/2022

Retail and payments, POS and forecourt systems.

- Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning.

PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM), BUNDESDRUCKEREI, BERLIN | 03/2021 - 06/2021

Government, secure data platform.

- Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY), AOK ITSCARE, FRANKFURT | 03/2019 - 05/2020

Health insurance, B2B procurement webshop.

- Migrated a legacy system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories and acceptance criteria in Jira.

PROJECT LEAD, ENERCON, WISMAR / MAGDEBURG | 04/2019 - 12/2019

Wind energy, full site IT modernisation end to end.

PRODUCT OWNER, WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN, ISNY | 08/2017 - 06/2018

Healthcare, clinical network. Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER TRACK

FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER, CONSTRUCT8, LIMASSOL | 12/2025 - 06/2026

- Construction staffing B2B marketplace, zero to one: anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel, SQL-based funnel and conversion analysis.

CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER, QCRYPT AG, BERLIN | 01/2016 - 12/2021

- IT security, quantum-secure encryption hardware and software. Shipped a three-layer product that installs in under two minutes to meet enterprise deployment constraints. Later Chair of the board.

FOUNDER AND CFO, KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS, BERLIN | 02/2013 - 11/2018

- Fintech, mobile group-based P2P payments. Built from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.
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§ SKILLS

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and product roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support, KPI (key performance indicator) definition.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, backlog refinement, sprint planning, sprint review, retrospective, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART, PI planning.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management and expectation alignment, cross-functional team leadership, C-level and executive reporting, workshop facilitation, client advisory, conflict resolution, change management.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance and Business: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ EDUCATION

DIPLOM-WIRTSCHAFTSINGENIEUR (INDUSTRIAL ENGINEERING AND MANAGEMENT, EQUIVALENT TO A MASTER'S DEGREE), TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN (TU BERLIN), GERMANY | 10/2006 - 09/2014

- Specialisation: Logistics. Thesis with Siemens AG Energy Service on balancing-power market profitability.

§ LANGUAGES

German (native speaker, C2) · English (C2, business and technical fluency)

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)

